# Prime Power



**Parminder Chopra, *56***
***CMD, Power Finance Corporation***

RAJWANT RAWAT

**ACCOMPLISHMENT**

**Parminder assumes the reins of PFC as its first woman head at a time when the world's focus on clean energy transition is sharper than ever**

**PARMINDER CHOPRA BELIEVES IN DREAMING** big, and dreaming fearlessly. So, in August 2023, when at age 56 she took charge as the chairperson and managing director of the Power Finance Corporation (PFC), India's largest non-banking financial company (NBFC), she was aware of one thing. That, beyond making history as the first woman to head the state-owned company, she was also undertaking a crucial responsibility at a time transitioning to clean energy has become a common agenda for the world. And thus, financing energy transition projects became her priority.

In the backdrop of the recent G20 summit, the NBFC signed MoUs worth Rs 2.37 lakh crore with over 20 companies for clean energy projects. "It's not merely about supporting projects in clean energy, it's holding the mantle to lead the transformation in the power sector," says Parminder, who has been in the sector for over three decades now and also holds the charge of director (finance) at PFC.

The PFC, which supports almost 50 per cent of India's total installed capacity, is also looking inward under Parminder's leadership. She is in the process of rolling out a plan to integrate ESG (environment, social, governance) practices within the organisation's functioning. "It isn't just a checkbox; it's a pledge. It's about weaving sustainability into the fabric of our operations," she says. Parminder is also working towards diversifying the institution's funding and reducing its reliance on the domestic market. "As they say, don't put all your eggs in one basket, so I have introduced active foreign borrowing in PFC, where we can tap funding from investors across the globe," she says. Over time, PFC's foreign borrowings have increased to 20 per cent of the total borrowings.

Parminder, who holds a bachelor's degree in commerce from Delhi University and is a qualified cost and management accountant, says her family has been her biggest cheerleader. She also wants her children to understand the value of hard work. "I want them to understand that there are no shortcuts to success." ■

***–Sonal Khetarpal***

**EMBRACING CHANGE**

"One must be open to navigating new grounds and not afraid of making mistakes. Also, gender doesn't define capability"

**A TURNING POINT**

**In the initial phase of her career, she got an opportunity to work with the CMD. The experience changed her perspective, allowing her to view things from a higher vantage point**